OPI · GEL · INFLUENCER MARKETING

Plan Your Three Weeks.

A spec campaign concept by Sresha Rajesh. Not affiliated with or endorsed by OPI.

CLIENT	OPI (gel manicure campaign concept)
DISCIPLINE	Influencer marketing: partner strategy, creator tiers, content pillars, disclosure guardrails
DELIVERABLES	Three-week gel planner · Nail tech partner brief · This case study
STATUS	Spec campaign. Independent concept work, not a real client engagement.

The Opportunity

OPI began in 1981, when George Schaeffer bought a small dental supply company then called Odontorium Products Inc. and, with Suzi Weiss-Fischmann, turned it into a nail brand. It was acquired by Coty in 2010 and, since 2020, has sat within Wella Company under KKR. Its Intelli-Gel system is described in trade coverage as a self-levelling, vegan, HEMA-free gel with up to three weeks of professional wear, made for salon professionals and their clients.

Nail marketing usually sells color. But people book gel because of something on their calendar. The three-week wear window is the most useful fact about the product, and it is rarely the headline.

Positioning

For people with a big moment in the next three weeks, OPI gel is the manicure planned around the calendar, not just the color. Unlike a color-first campaign, it starts with what is coming up and leaves the shade and finish to the nail tech who knows the client's hands.

The Influencer Marketing Work

- Partner strategy: independent nail techs, not celebrities, are the creators, following OPI's own positioning as a brand built in service of nail professionals.
- Tiering: three partner tiers (chair-side, creator techs, anchor partners) with different asks and rewards.
- Content pillars: The Three-Week Plan, Day 1 to Day 21, and Ask Your Tech.
- Guardrails: FTC-aligned disclosure, no guaranteed wear, no health claims, no retouching that changes the look.

Deliverables Prototyped

- Three-week planner: pick a big moment (interview, wedding, trip, new job) and a finish, and get a color family, a three-week plan and a script to read out in the chair. Color families are illustrative, not OPI shade recommendations.
- Nail tech partner brief: an 8-section influencer brief covering problem, partner rationale, positioning, content pillars, tiers, guardrails, measurement and risks.

How This Would Be Measured

Because this is spec work, there are no real results to report. If it ran, this is how it would be measured:

- Primary KPI: gel bookings attributed to partner QR codes and planner links, per partner.

- Secondary KPIs: planner completions, share of clients who rebook inside the three-week window, saves and shares per post, cost per booking by tier.
- Channels: Instagram Reels and Stories, TikTok, in-salon QR cards, paid amplification of top partner posts.
- Budget split (illustrative): 45% partner fees and kits, 30% paid amplification, 15% planner and QR materials, 10% education events.
- Test plan: occasion-led videos against color-led videos to see which drives more bookings per post.

A Note on Accuracy

OPI's 1981 start, original name, co-founders, 2007 reformulation, Coty's 2010 acquisition and the 2020 sale to KKR are from Wikipedia's OPI Products article. The Intelli-Gel claims (self-levelling, vegan, HEMA-free, three weeks of professional wear, around 100 shades, available in North America) are from trade coverage of the launch in Drug Store News and Scratch Magazine, which disagree slightly on shade count. Disclosure guidance is from the FTC's Disclosures 101 for Social Media Influencers. Partner tiers, content, color families, budget and all measurement plans are original creative work and not real OPI strategy or performance data. Details may change, so re-check opi.com before sharing publicly.